

# The Threshold Compendium

*An Investigation into the Unquiet Dead, the Cursed, and the Hungry*

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*Invoker of The Witness, Seeker of the Threshold*

The ink is ash and silver. The mirror is clean.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

# Preface

I did not seek this work. It found me, as such things always do, in the space between the tide and the truth.

The waters of the Amaranthine do not give up their dead easily. I learned this as a young lieutenant, pulling bodies from the wreck of the *Mistral* – a Kahfagian cutter that had run afoul of something that had no business being in the shallows. The sailors had not drowned. I will not describe what I saw, except to say that I spent the next three years learning that the world is older and hungrier than the Admiralty's charts admit.

The attack on the cultists of Khemesh – that ill-fated expedition that claimed so many good men and women – left me broken on a beach on the Dhaharan coast. I washed ashore with salt in my lungs and a silver mirror in my hand that had not been there when I went under. When I opened my eyes, I saw not the sky, but a reflection of something that had been watching me for a very long time.

The Witness does not speak. It *shows*.

What follows is not a grimoire in the traditional sense. I have no interest in teaching the eager how to summon what should remain sealed. This is a casebook – a compendium of observations, autopsies, interrogations, and the hard-won wisdom of twenty years walking the edge between the living and the hungry.

I have organized this work by category, though I caution the reader that the categories are not clean. A ghost may become a ghoul, given enough hunger and the right soil. A demon may wear a vampire's mask. The lycanthrope's curse is kin to the plague-bearer's affliction, and both answer to Malachai's silver tongue.

The Witness demands truth. I have given it as I have found it.

Saikou Ira  
Port Shed, Dhaharan Coast  
The ink is ash and silver. The mirror is clean.

## A Note on Patrons and Tools

I am an Invoker. I carry no Codex carved in stone, no Thiasos bound by oath. I carry *Symbols* – physical anchors to Patrons I have learned to bargain with, each for a specific purpose. Over years of walking the edge, I have found four powers that answer when I call.

**The Witness** My first and most constant patron. It shows me what is hidden, reveals the truth beneath the lie, and guides my investigations. When I place a silver mirror, I invoke The Witness. Its domain is revelation, memory, and the unbearable clarity of the seen.

**The Traveler** Lord of roads, waystations, and the space between departure and arrival. I call on The Traveler when I must escape a trap, find a path that does not appear on any map, or simply arrive before my pursuers. Its gifts are subtle – a shortcut that should not exist, a door that opens to the right alley, a helpful stranger who speaks the language of the road.

**Raéyn** Mistress of the sea, storms, and the tide that does not forgive. I invoke Raéyn when I am desperate – when the water rises, when the ship is sinking, when the creature from the deep has me in its grip. Her favor is fickle, but her wrath is absolute.

**The Sentinel** (Some call it the Sealed Gate.) Patron of thresholds, wards, and the boundary between what belongs and what must be kept out. I call on The Sentinel to exorcise spirits, to seal a room against possession, to draw the line that nothing may cross. Its power is that of the *witnessed barrier* – a line of salt blessed by a third party, a mirror facing a door, a vow spoken in the presence of two watchers.

In the chapters that follow, I will describe – when relevant – how I have used these patrons in particular cases. The rituals are not provided as instructions. They are provided as *evidence* that such bargains are possible. Whether you choose to walk the same roads is your own affair.

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## Part I

# The Unquiet Dead





## 0.1 The Spirit Taxonomy

The dead do not remain for a single reason, nor do they manifest in a single form. Over years of investigation—and, I confess, more than a few exorcisms conducted in haste—I have developed a working taxonomy of the unquiet. This is not an academic exercise. The method of laying a spirit to rest depends entirely upon *why* it remains and *how* it manifests.

### 0.1.1 Class I: The Echo

The Echo is not truly a spirit. It is a *recording*—a psychic imprint left by a traumatic death, repeated endlessly until the conditions that created it are addressed. Echoes do not speak, do not learn, and cannot be negotiated with. They are the scream that plays again at midnight, the footsteps that cross the same corridor at the same hour, the face that appears in the window of a house that burned a century ago.

**Investigation Notes:** Echoes require witness to fade. A single observer who speaks aloud the truth of the event—who names the dead and describes their end—will often break the loop. If the death was unjust, the Echo may persist until justice is done. In such cases, I have found that a public acknowledgment of the wrong, witnessed by a representative of the community, suffices where private ritual fails.

**The Witness’s Technique:** When I encounter an Echo, I place a small silvered mirror facing the site of the imprint. The Echo will play once into the glass. Afterward, the mirror may be shattered—each shard holds a fragment of the memory, which can be used in later investigations or ritually cleansed.

**Case Study: *The Lamplighter of the Third Stack*** (Aelerian Ranges, 847). A miner’s death in a gas explosion repeated every night at the same hour. The Echo was not the man’s death, but his final attempt to ring the warning bell. We placed a recording mirror at the gallery entrance, then had the mine’s foreman read the names of all who had died in that disaster into the glass. The Echo ceased. The foreman slept peacefully for the first time in thirty years.

### 0.1.2 Class II: The Anchor

An Anchor is a spirit bound to a specific object, location, or person by unresolved emotion—grief, rage, love, or duty. Unlike the Echo, an Anchor possesses will and memory. It can speak, bargain, and choose to manifest or withhold itself. It is, in essence, a person who has forgotten how to leave.

#### Variants by Cultural Tradition:

- *The Hearth-Bound* (*Vilikari, Aelaerem*): Spirits of grandparents or parents who refuse to depart until they have ensured the flourishing of their descendants. These Anchors are generally benevolent, though they may become irritable if their advice is ignored repeatedly.
- *The Duty-Bound* (*Aeler, Kahfagia*): Soldiers, watchmen, and sailors who died at their post and continue to perform their duty. I once met a lighthouse keeper who had been dead for seven years. The lamp never went out. He did not speak, but his logbook was written in a hand that was not quite attached to a wrist.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

- *The Wronged (Universally encountered)*: Victims of murder, betrayal, or accident who refuse to pass until their death is acknowledged and, where possible, avenged. These are the most dangerous Anchors, as their grief curdles into something that resembles hunger.

**Investigation Notes:** An Anchor cannot be exorcised by force without risk of creating a Poltergeist (Class IV). The proper method is negotiation. Determine what the spirit requires to complete its business. Offer witness—a third party who will attest to the resolution. In cases where the spirit’s demand is impossible (the murderer died decades ago, the lover has since remarried), a ritual of substitution may suffice.

**The Witness’s Technique:** I conduct Anchor interrogations in a room with three mirrors—one facing the spirit, one facing myself, and one placed between us to catch the reflection of the truth. The Anchor cannot lie in the space between two reflections. It may refuse to speak, but it cannot deceive.

**Case Study: *The Widow of the Red Tower*** (Vhasia, 852). A noblewoman’s ghost haunted her husband’s estate, refusing to pass until he confessed to poisoning her. I placed three mirrors in the great hall and asked the spirit to show me her death. The reflection did not lie. The husband confessed before dawn. The widow vanished with a smile that I still see in my dreams.

### 0.1.3 Class III: The Procession

A Procession is not a single spirit, but a *route*—a path that the dead walk, sometimes for centuries, between two points of significance. Processions are most common in regions where death was sudden and widespread: battlefields, plague pits, shipwreck coasts.

#### Characteristics:

- Processions occur on a regular schedule (nightly, monthly, on the anniversary of the disaster).
- They follow a fixed route that predates the current roads.
- The spirits within a Procession do not interact with observers. They are *marching*, not haunting.
- Interrupting a Procession—by standing in its path, attempting to speak to its members, or building over its route—provokes a violent response from the entire column.

**Investigation Notes:** Processions are not malevolent, but they are *inflexible*. The proper response is to observe, document, and—if the route must be altered—negotiate with the *destination*, not the dead. If a Procession marches to a specific grave or shrine, moving that terminus will often reroute the spirits.

**The Traveler’s Intervention:** When I need to cross where a Procession walks, I invoke The Traveler. A single pinch of road dust from a crossroads where three murders occurred, blown toward the column, causes the spirits to *step aside* for exactly the time needed to pass. I have used this technique four times. On three occasions, it worked. On the fourth, the Procession followed me for a week. I do not recommend relying on this method unless you are prepared to run.

**Case Study: *The Phantom Caravan of the Saffron Pass*** (Dhahara, 855). A merchant’s new road cut directly across the path of a weekly Procession. The column attacked every merchant who

attempted the crossing. I consulted with a Fhara caravaneer, who revealed that the Procession was marching from an old well to a date grove. We moved a single stone—a marker that had served as the terminus—to the side of the new road. The Procession followed the stone. The road was safe by nightfall.

#### 0.1.4 Class IV: The Poltergeist

The Poltergeist is an Anchor that has been corrupted by rage, starvation, or the failure of negotiation. It is no longer a person—it is a *wound* that has learned to strike back. Poltergeists manifest as telekinetic force, localized environmental disturbances, and, in advanced cases, violent possession of the living.

##### Stages of Poltergeist Development:

**Stage One (The Knock):** Unexplained sounds, objects shifting slightly between observations, drafts in sealed rooms.

**Stage Two (The Grasp):** Objects thrown with force, doors slamming, furniture overturned. Living creatures experience nightmares, nausea, and a persistent sense of being watched.

**Stage Three (The Hunger):** The Poltergeist begins to feed on fear and pain. It will target specific individuals, escalating from psychological torment to physical harm. Bruises, scratches, and broken bones become common.

**Stage Four (The Mask):** The Poltergeist possesses a living host, using their body to commit acts of violence. Exorcism at this stage is dangerous and often fatal to the host.

**Exorcism with The Sentinel:** The Sentinel’s power is that of the witnessed boundary. I perform the following ritual:

1. Identify the Anchor’s original location of death or burial. This is the *root*.
2. Surround the root with a circle of salt and iron filings, blessed by a representative of the local faith. (The Sentinel does not care which faith; only that the witness is genuine.)
3. Place a silvered mirror at each cardinal point within the circle, facing outward.
4. Speak the name of the dead three times—once for acknowledgment, once for judgment, once for release.
5. Shatter the mirrors simultaneously. The Sentinel seals the break.

This ritual does not *destroy* the Poltergeist. It returns it to the state of an Anchor, at which point standard negotiation may resume.

**Case Study: *The Plague House of Port Shed*** (Dhaharan Coast, 858). A family of Sidhi dockworkers was being terrorized by a Poltergeist in Stage Three. The Anchor was a young woman who had died of a fever three months prior—not violently, but *alone*, her family having quarantined her. I performed The Sentinel’s containment. At the moment of release, I placed a small hand mirror in the center of the circle, reflecting her own face. The Poltergeist collapsed into a weeping Anchor. She passed into the care of a local medium. She has not returned.

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## Part II

# The Hungry



## 0.2 Ghouls and the Flesh-Eaters

The ghoul is not a single creature, but a *state*—a progression from unquiet death to active predation. I have encountered ghouls in every region of the Amaranthine, from the frozen barrows of Linn to the sun-baked crypts of Ashaan. Their origins are varied, but their behavior is remarkably consistent.

### 0.2.1 The Three Origins

#### Origin One: The Starved Anchor

An Anchor that is denied resolution for too long may begin to consume the life force of the living to sustain its own existence. These ghouls retain their intelligence and memory. They are the most dangerous, because they are the most *pitiable*.

#### Origin Two: The Corpse-Fed

A body buried in ground that is rich in death—a battlefield, a plague pit, a site of repeated sacrifice—may rise as a ghoul regardless of the soul’s disposition. These ghouls are *reanimated corpses*, not spirits. They have no memory of their former lives. Fire stops them. Decapitation stops them. Nothing else does.

#### Origin Three: The Cursed

Malachai’s touch takes many forms. The ghoul is one of her simpler curses—a gift to those who begged for immortality and received a half-life of hunger instead. These ghouls retain their intelligence, but their morality erodes over time.

### 0.2.2 Investigation Notes

- Ghouls cannot digest food. They consume living flesh to absorb *life essence*.
- They are vulnerable to silver, but not to the same degree as vampires or lycanthropes. A silver blade wounds them; fire destroys them.
- A ghoul that has not fed for a month will enter a state of torpor, appearing dead. It can be buried safely, but if disturbed, it will wake ravenous.
- There is no known cure for ghoullism. The Well of Ichor in Zahk’Kozahn offers release, but the price is memory.

**Raéyn’s Mercy:** When I must destroy a ghoul that was once a good person, I invoke Raéyn. A cup of seawater blessed in her name, thrown onto the creature’s remains after destruction, ensures that the soul will not rise again. The water must be thrown by a witness who did not participate in the killing—a bystander, a family member, a priest. Raéyn demands that the killer and the witness be separate. I do not know why, but I obey.

**Case Study: *The Dock-Rat of Port Shed*** (Dhaharan Coast, 860). A young Sidhi woman was infected with ghoullism after drinking from a cursed well. She hid her condition for two years, feeding

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

on stray animals. When she could no longer control the hunger, she fled into the sewers. I found her—starved, weeping, clutching letters to her mother. I negotiated a feeding schedule: animal blood, provided by a local butcher in exchange for her labor as a night watchman (ghouls do not sleep, and their senses are sharp). She has not harmed a human in five years. Her mother knows. The butcher knows. I have told no one else.



## Part III

# The Cursed



## 0.3 Lycanthropes

The werewolf is a creature of paradox: a curse that feels like freedom, a transformation that erases the self, a hunger that is also a family. I have tracked lycanthropes across three continents. I have killed two. I have saved four.

### 0.3.1 Origins and Cultural Variations

Lycanthropy is a *spiritual infection*—a fragment of Malachai’s chained essence passed from host to host through violence, but only if the victim is in a state of profound emotional vulnerability.

**Linn Sea-Wolf:** Transforms into a massive seal or walrus. Solitary, melancholic, preys on ships.

**Ykrul Sky-Hound:** Hawk-headed hunter that transforms during the day. Hunts oath-breakers, not flesh.

**Valewood Root-Walker:** Transforms into a tree—rooted, immobile, but all-seeing. Guardians, not predators.

**Aeler Stone-Hide:** Massive, slow, nearly invulnerable. Transforms only underground. A mining hazard.

### 0.3.2 Investigation Notes

- Silver through the heart or brain kills them.
- Aconite (wolfsbane) poultice applied within the hour can prevent transformation.
- The full moon is not a universal trigger; transformation responds to *emotional* cycles.
- The Well of Ichor can purge lycanthropy, but the journey to Zahk’Kozahn is itself a trial.

**The Witness’s Observation:** Lycanthropes who remember their human lives clearly are less dangerous than those who do not. The memory of love acts as a leash on the beast.

**Case Study: *The Hunters of the Scarlet Wood*** (Crimson Valley, 862). A pack of feral lycanthropes with no memory. I placed a mirror at the cave entrance. As the first wolf emerged, it saw its own reflection—and for a moment, I saw recognition. That wolf was a young silk-weaver who had gone missing two years prior. I spoke her name. She stopped. We negotiated a quarantine. She now feeds on deer and speaks to her daughter through a silvered glass.

## 0.4 Vampires

Vampires are the eldest children of Malachai, the first to drink from the Chained Angel’s wound.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

### 0.4.1 The Thirteen First Vampires

I have met three of the Thirteen. I will describe them briefly, as a warning.

**Baron Quentin Asselin:** The first to drink. Disillusioned, melancholic, almost gentle. Converts guests or drives them mad. *Never accept his wine.*

**Sister Maris:** Runs a children’s hospice. The children never leave. The Everflame has tried to destroy her hospice four times. Each time, the children defended her.

**The Sparrow:** Kills only the wicked, or so he claims. Cannot look at mirrors. Has saved my life twice. I suspect he is merely *bored*.

### 0.4.2 Lesser Bloodlines

- **Linn Draugr:** Breathe underwater, trapped by sea-salt circles.
- **Aeler Stone-Sleepers:** Drink breath, awakened by bronze bells at dawn.
- **Ykrul Bone-Eaters:** Turn to dust when killed, but rise if their name is spoken. Erase the name.
- **Vhasian Candle-Wights:** Extinguish flames through windows. A lit candle at the threshold bars them.
- **Lethai-ar Silk-Drinkers:** Feed on desire. Vulnerable to vows witnessed by a third party.

**The Sentinel’s Ward:** When I must enter a vampire’s lair, I invoke The Sentinel to bless the threshold of my mind. A silver mirror worn over the heart, inscribed with the sigil of the Sealed Gate, prevents the vampire’s hypnotic gaze from finding purchase. I have walked into the dens of three vampires wearing that mirror. Only once did I have to run.

**Case Study: *The Court Painter of Mbaro*** (Oshiira, 856). A Silk-Drinker feeding on nobles’ ambition. I confronted him in the Widow’s weigh-house. He did not flee. He wept and confessed. The Widow commuted his death sentence to indefinite confinement in a silver-lined cell. He paints the Widow’s portrait each year. She has not aged in seven years. I do not know if this is related.

## Part IV

# The Bound



## 0.5 Demons and the Infernal

I use the term *demon* with reluctance. The entities that the Church of the Everflame calls demons are not a unified species. They are a *category of convenience*—spirits that refuse to abide by the covenants of mortal society, that cannot be negotiated with in the language of debt and obligation.

### 0.5.1 Classification by Behavior

**Class A: The Tempter** Offers power, knowledge, revenge in exchange for a price. Bound by the letter of contracts. A contract witnessed by a Runekeeper of Mykkiel can be enforced.

**Class B: The Ravager** Simple hunger, rage, destruction. Summoned by violence or mass death. Vulnerable to silver and fire, but the most effective banishment is *overwhelming witness*.

**Class C: The Possessor** Inhabits living hosts, gradually erasing the host’s personality. Vulnerable to exorcism by representatives of the *host’s* faith.

**Class D: The Parasite** Attaches to a single emotion (fear, grief, ambition) and grows stronger as the host experiences that emotion. Can be starved by rigorous emotional discipline.

### 0.5.2 Investigation Notes

- Demon summoning is forbidden in every nation that has a functioning legal system, and for good reason. Every summoning is a hole in the world.
- Demon hunters require three things: silver, fire, and witness.
- I carry a censer that burns a compound of saltpeter, silver filings, and ironwood resin. The smoke reveals demonic possession: the host’s shadow lags; the demon’s shadow moves ahead.

**The Sentinel’s Exorcism:** To exorcise a possessing demon, I invoke The Sentinel to draw a *witnessed circle* around the possessed. The circle must contain three mirrors—one facing the host, one facing the demon (reflected in the host’s eyes), and one facing the exorcist. I speak the demon’s true name (learned through The Witness’s revelation) three times. On the third utterance, the demon is forced into the central mirror. The mirror is then shattered, and The Sentinel seals each shard. The demon is not destroyed, but it is *distributed*—too fragmented to act.

**Case Study: *The Censor’s Daughter*** (Ecktoria, 859). A young woman possessed by a Class C demon. The Everflame Inquisition was preparing to burn her. I conducted The Sentinel’s exorcism. The demon—a Tempter—had been summoned by the girl’s own father, a Censor who hoped to influence a trial. The father confessed. The demon was sealed. The girl survived. She now works as an archivist. She does not speak of those days.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —



## Part V

# The Thirteenth Chime



## 0.6 Conclusion: On the Necessity of Witness

I have written this compendium not to frighten, but to *prepare*. The creatures I have described are not myths. They are neighbors, patients, clients, and—sometimes—the faces we see in the mirror when we are alone at midnight.

The Witness has taught me that truth is not a weapon. It is a *tool*. The truth reveals the weak point, the bargain, the memory that binds the spirit to its hunger.

I have killed. I have saved. I have wept over bodies I could not help and celebrated over curses I could not break.

The work continues.

If you are reading this, you are now a witness. The creatures I have described are real. They are hungry. They are waiting.

But so are we.

The ninth cup is not poured. The ninth bell is not rung. The threshold is held—by you, by me, by the quiet ones who tend the lamps and count the breaths and remember the names that others have forgotten.

Do not look away.

Saikou Ira  
Port Shed, Dhaharan Coast  
The mirror is clean. The truth is waiting.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

## Part VI

# Appendices



## **.1 Field Procedures**

*For the use of investigators, exorcists, and those who walk the edge.*

### **.1.1 The Silver Test**

Carry a small silver coin. When you suspect a supernatural presence, place the coin on your tongue. If the coin tastes of copper or blood, you are in the presence of a vampire, lycanthrope, or demon. If the coin remains tasteless, the threat is spiritual (ghost, poltergeist, Anchor) rather than physical.

*Do not swallow the coin.*

### **.1.2 The Mirror Array (The Witness)**

To seal a room against possession or haunting:

1. Place a silvered mirror facing each doorway.
2. Place a mirror facing each window.
3. Place a single mirror in the center of the room, facing the ceiling.

Clean the mirrors with salt water before placement. The central mirror serves as a *focus*—any spirit that attempts to enter will see its own reflection and hesitate.

### **.1.3 The Traveler’s Shortcut**

When you need to bypass a patrol, a locked door, or a stretch of dangerous road, hold a pinch of dust from a crossroads in your left hand and whisper: *“The road that was not there, I walk it now.”* Throw the dust into the air. If The Traveler is listening, a path will open. It will not last long. Do not hesitate.

### **.1.4 Raéyn’s Desperation**

If you are drowning or trapped beneath the waves, speak Raéyn’s name three times and touch silver to salt water. She may grant you a single breath—enough to reach the surface or to strike one blow. This favor is never forgotten. She will ask for something in return, usually on a night when the tide is wrong and the wind is silent.

### **.1.5 The Sentinel’s Ward (Exorcism)**

To exorcise a possessing demon:

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

1. Draw a circle of salt and iron filings around the possessed. The circle must have *three* witnesses: one who loves the victim, one who fears the demon, and one who is neutral.
2. Place three mirrors: one facing the victim, one facing the demon (reflected in the victim's eyes), and one facing the exorcist.
3. Speak the demon's true name three times, learned through The Witness's revelation.
4. On the third utterance, the demon is forced into the central mirror.
5. Shatter the mirror with a silver hammer. The Sentinel seals each shard.

*The demon is not destroyed. It is distributed. It cannot act, but it may be reassembled by a skilled summoner. Dispose of the shards in separate bodies of water.*

### **.1.6 The Witness's Knot**

When interviewing a suspect who may be possessed or cursed, tie a red thread around your left wrist and the suspect's right wrist. Explain that the knot binds the truth. Speak your questions clearly. The suspect cannot lie while the knot holds—but the knot will tighten if the truth is painful. Cut the knot when the interview concludes. Do not reuse the thread.

### **.1.7 The Salt Line**

A continuous line of salt will bar most spirits and lesser cursed creatures. Use sea salt for Linn creatures, rock salt for Aeler entities, and salt blessed by any faith for general purposes. A single break—a finger's width—is enough for a determined spirit to cross.

### **.1.8 The Ninth Measure**

When you encounter a creature or spirit that seems to have no weakness, look for what is *missing*. The ninth cup un-poured. The ninth bell un-rung. The ninth name unspoken. The ninth step uncounted. Fill the absence, and the creature will sometimes cease. *I do not know why this works. I do not ask.*



## .2 Creature Stat Blocks

*For use with the Fate's Edge system. These statistics are drawn from Saikou's case files.*

### .2.1 Echo (Class I Spirit)

|                       |                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | I                                                                                    |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 1 (non-combatant)                                                                    |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Incorporeal, Repetitive, Trapped                                                     |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | None (cannot harm directly)                                                          |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Distraction (SB: 1 to create a sensory illusion), Delay (SB: 2 to cause a time loop) |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Witness a truth about the death (DV 3) to banish permanently.                        |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Echo's Loop [4] — when filled, the Echo expands its range.                           |

### .2.2 Anchor (Class II Spirit)

|                       |                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | II–III                                                                                       |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 2–4                                                                                          |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Incorporeal, Intelligent, Bound                                                              |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | Manifestation (DV 3, Fatigue 1), Poltergeist Shove (DV 4, Harm 1)                            |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Bargain Required — cannot be fought; must negotiate.                                         |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Fulfill the Anchor's unfinished business, or perform a witnessed substitution ritual (DV 4). |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Anchor's Patience [6] — when filled, the Anchor becomes a Poltergeist.                       |

### .2.3 Poltergeist (Class IV Spirit)

|                       |                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | III–IV                                                                                          |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 3–5                                                                                             |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Incorporeal, Raging, Hungry                                                                     |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | Telekinetic Throw (DV 3, Harm 2), Possession Attempt (DV 4, Spirit+Resist or Controlled)        |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Aura of Fear (all actions Desperate within Near range), Environmental Collapse (clocks advance) |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Containment ritual (The Sentinel) followed by negotiation with the underlying Anchor.           |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Poltergeist Escalation [8] — when filled, the spirit reaches Stage Four.                        |

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

**.2.4 Ghoul (Starved Anchor)**

|                       |                                                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | II–III                                                                         |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 2–4                                                                            |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Corporeal, Hungry, Intelligent                                                 |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | Claw (DV 2, Harm 1 + Fatigue 1), Bite (DV 3, Harm 2 + poison)                  |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Regeneration (ignore first 2 Harm each scene), Ravenous (must feed or frenzy)  |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Silver weapon to the heart, or fire. Negotiation possible if the ghoul is fed. |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Hunger [6] — when filled, the ghoul attacks indiscriminately.                  |

**.2.5 Lycanthrope (Linn Sea-Wolf)**

|                       |                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | III                                                                                                          |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 4                                                                                                            |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Shapechanger, Amphibious, Solitary                                                                           |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | Claw (DV 2, Harm 2), Drowning Grasp (DV 4, Harm 1 + Suffocation)                                             |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Silver Vulnerability (+2 Harm from silver), Transformation Trigger (first winter storm after a kill)         |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Silver weapon to the heart or brain. Aconite poultice can prevent transformation if applied within the hour. |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Moon’s Hunger [6] — when filled, the lycanthrope enters a frenzy.                                            |

**.2.6 Vampire (Lesser Bloodline)**

|                       |                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>          | III                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Cap:</b>           | 4                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Traits:</b>        | Undead, Hypnotic Gaze, Blood Drain                                                                                    |
| <b>Attacks:</b>       | Claw (DV 2, Harm 1), Blood Drain (DV 3, Harm 1 + 1 Fatigue to victim, heals vampire 1 Harm)                           |
| <b>Complications:</b> | Sunlight Vulnerability (1 Harm per round in direct sun), Invitation Required (cannot enter a home without invitation) |
| <b>Resolution:</b>    | Stake through the heart (DV 5, must be wooden), decapitation, fire.                                                   |
| <b>Clocks:</b>        | Thirst [6] — when filled, the vampire loses control and feeds openly.                                                 |

**.2.7 Demon (Class C Possessor)**

|                              |                                                                                            |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier:</b>                 | IV                                                                                         |
| <b>Cap:</b>                  | 5                                                                                          |
| <b>Traits:</b>               | Incorporeal (unless possessing), Intelligent, Malicious                                    |
| <b>Attacks (possessing):</b> | Use host’s physical stats +2, plus fear aura (DV 3, Fear effect)                           |
| <b>Complications:</b>        | Cannot be harmed directly while possessing; exorcism required.                             |
| <b>Resolution:</b>           | The Sentinel’s exorcism ritual (DV 5, requires three witnesses and the demon’s true name). |
| <b>Clocks:</b>               | Possession Depth [8] — when filled, the host is permanently erased.                        |

## .3 Adventure Seeds

Three scenarios drawn from Saikou Ira's unsolved cases. GMs are free to adapt them to their campaigns.

### .3.1 The Lamplighter's Echo

**Setup:** In an Aeler mining town, the Echo of a lamplighter killed in a gas explosion has begun to manifest during the night shift. The Echo does not harm anyone, but its warning bell confuses the miners and has caused two accidents. The mine foreman wants to blast the tunnel where the lamplighter died. The lamplighter's widow begs the party to find another way.

**Complications:** The Echo is not the lamplighter's death—it is his final attempt to ring the warning bell. The bell itself was salvaged and now hangs in the town's chapel. The lamplighter's name has been forgotten; the widow is the only one who remembers.

**Resolution:** The party must retrieve the bell and ring it during the next manifestation, while the widow speaks her husband's name. The Echo will cease. If they blast the tunnel, the Echo transforms into a Poltergeist.

**Clocks:**

- Foreman's Patience [4] — when filled, the foreman blasts the tunnel.
- Echo's Desperation [6] — when filled, the Echo becomes a Poltergeist.

### .3.2 The Ghoul of the Sewers

**Setup:** In Port Shed, a series of missing persons reports have been linked to the sewers beneath the spice warehouses. The party is hired by a Sidhi dock-master to investigate. The ghoul is a young woman who was cursed after drinking from a well contaminated by a broken Veiled Sister's seal. She does not want to kill; she is starving.

**Complications:** The woman's mother is still alive and has been leaving bowls of animal blood at the sewer entrance. The dock-master knows this and wants the party to *deal with* the ghoul quietly. A rival smuggler has learned of the ghoul and plans to use it as a weapon.

**Resolution:** The party may kill the ghoul (straightforward but morally ambiguous), arrange a feeding schedule (requires negotiation and a reliable source of animal blood), or attempt to cure her with a journey to the Well of Ichor (a mini-campaign).

**Clocks:**

- Hunger [4] — when filled, the ghoul attacks indiscriminately.
- Smuggler's Scheme [6] — when filled, a rival faction captures the ghoul.

— *The truth does not kill the vampire; the silver does.* —

### .3.3 The Possessed Censor's Daughter

**Setup:** In Ecktoria, a Censor's daughter is accused of witchcraft after her body begins to speak in languages she never learned. The Everflame Inquisition has arrested her and plans to burn her at the next Triumph. The Censor (the girl's father) secretly hired a summoner years ago to bind a Tempter demon to his family line; the demon has now passed to his daughter. He will not confess.

**Complications:** The demon's true name is recorded in a forbidden text held in the Censor's private archive. The archive is sealed with a ward that only The Sentinel can breach. The party must break into the archive, learn the name, and perform an exorcism before the Inquisition executes the girl.

**Resolution:** The party must choose between exposing the Censor (ruining his family but saving the girl), performing a secret exorcism (difficult, requires three witnesses and a safe location), or breaking the girl out of prison (leading to a fugitive arc).

**Clocks:**

- Inquisition's Schedule [6] — when filled, the girl is burned.
- Demon's Grip [8] — when filled, the demon permanently possesses the girl.

# Colophon

This compendium was written on the road between Dhahara and the Crimson Valley, on paper that had already served as a cargo manifest, a love letter, and a bandage. The ink is lamp-black cut with silver dust and the ash of a seal that belonged to a Censor who no longer exists.

The mirror is clean. The truth is waiting.

*The ink is fresh. The road is south.*